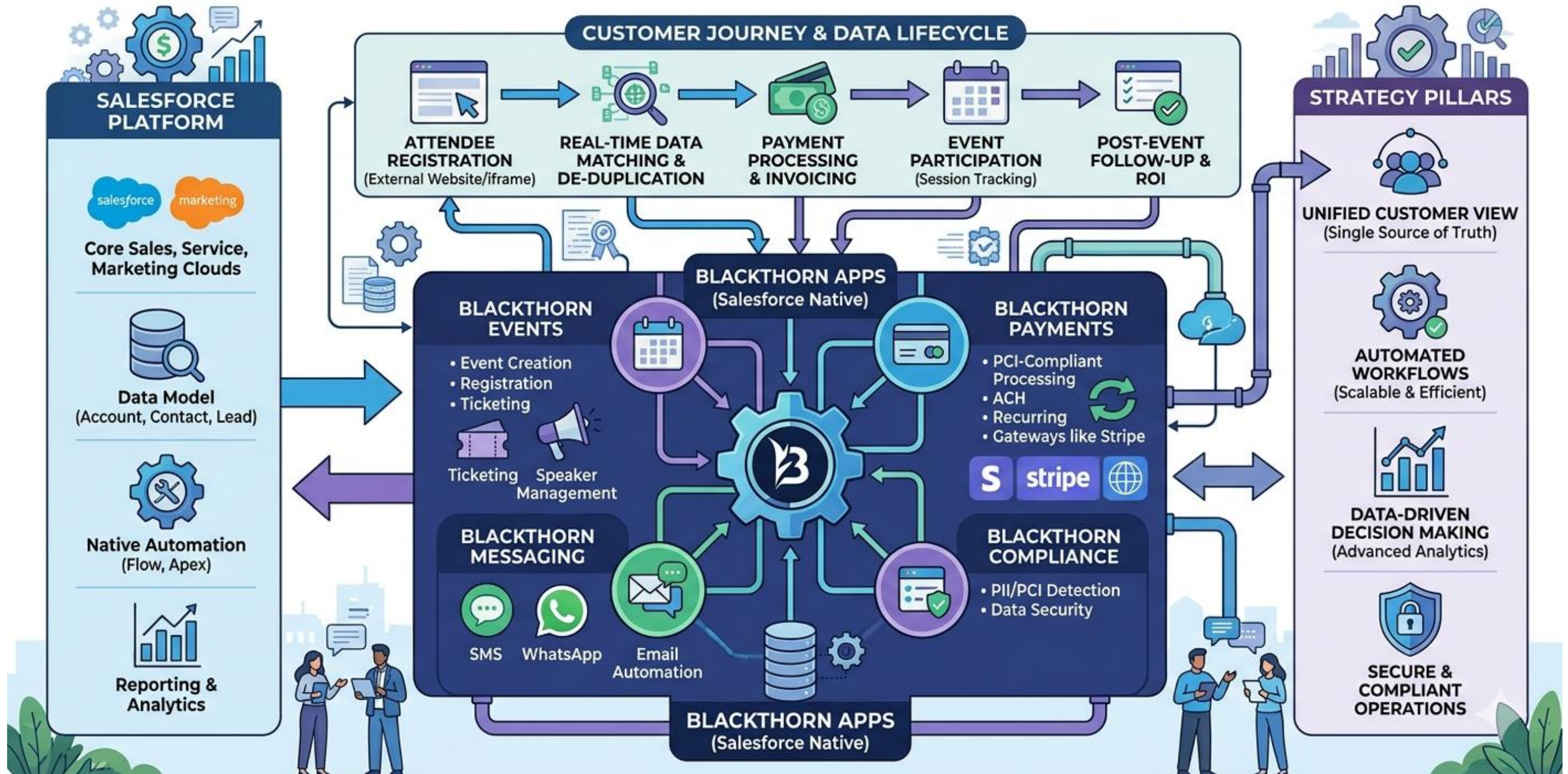


SALESFORCE AND BLACKTHORN INTEGRATION STRATEGY



Business Scenario & Objective

University Engagement team is launching a new event series powered by Blackthorn within Salesforce. The goal: create a unified operational and reporting backbone that scales with the program.

Track Registrations

Centralized visibility into event sign-ups and attendance



Manage Payments

Seamless payment processing for paid events



Capture Feedback

Post-event surveys linked to participant records



Leadership Reporting

Executive-ready dashboards with real-time KPIs



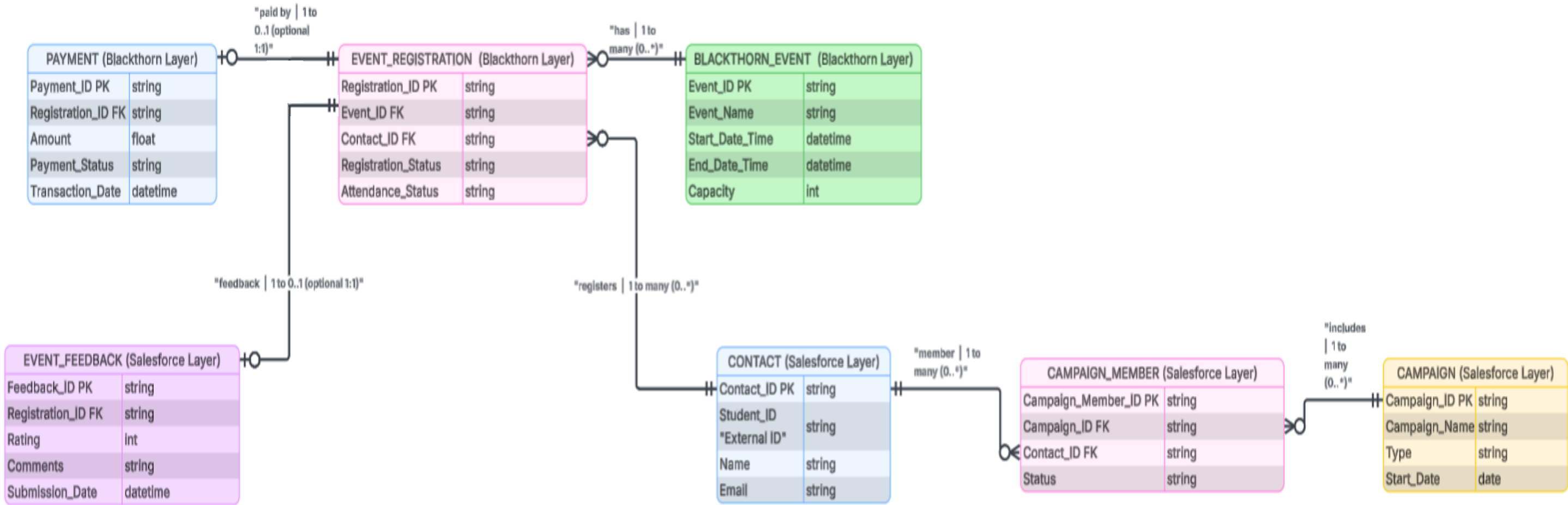
Solution Strategy

Two-Layer Architecture

Blackthorn operational layer — manages the full event lifecycle

Salesforce CRM engagement & reporting layer — drives analytics and visibility

Salesforce & Blackthorn ERD



Key Salesforce & Blackthorn Objects and Fields

Data architecture reference — Blackthorn managed package layer alongside Salesforce standard and custom CRM objects.

MANAGED PACKAGE

Blackthorn — Operational Layer

Blackthorn_Event

Stores event operational details.

PK: Event ID · Name · Start/End DateTime · Location · Capacity · Status

Event_Registration

Junction object: Event ↔ Contact.

PK: Registration ID · **FK:** Event ID · **FK:** Contact ID · Registration Status · Attendance Status

Payment

Tracks transaction records for paid events.

PK: Payment ID · **FK:** Registration ID · Amount · Payment Status · Transaction ID

STANDARD + CUSTOM

Salesforce — CRM Layer

Contact

Stores student identity and CRM attributes.

PK: Contact ID · Student ID (Ext. ID) · Name · Email · Program

Campaign

Event-level marketing tracking.

PK: Campaign ID · Name · Type · Status

Campaign Member

Tracks Contact ↔ Campaign engagement.

PK: Member ID · **FK:** Campaign ID · **FK:** Contact ID · Status

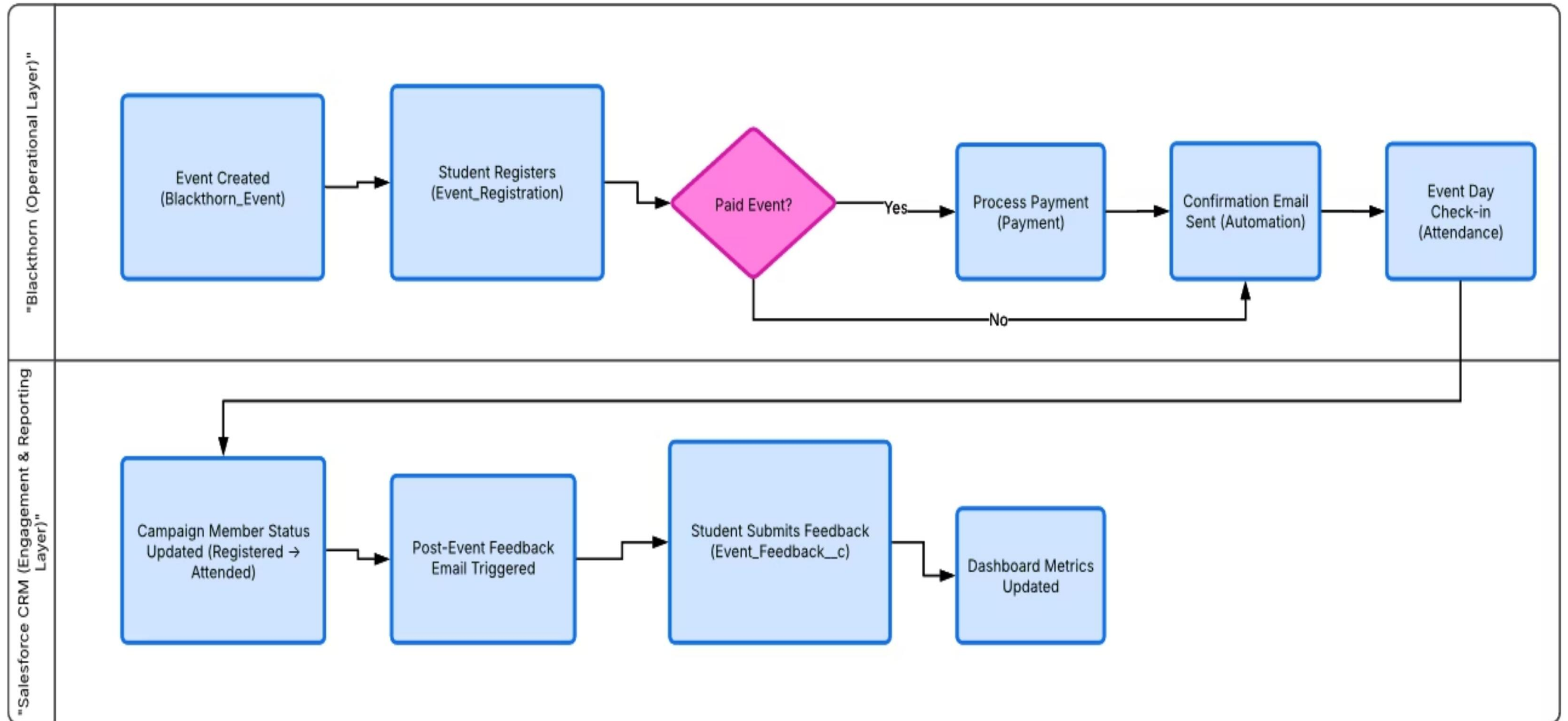
Event_Feedback__c (Custom)

Captures post-event satisfaction data.

PK: Feedback ID · **FK:** Registration ID · Rating · NPS · Comments

End-to-End Event Lifecycle

Each stage has a defined system of record and triggers downstream data updates across both layers.



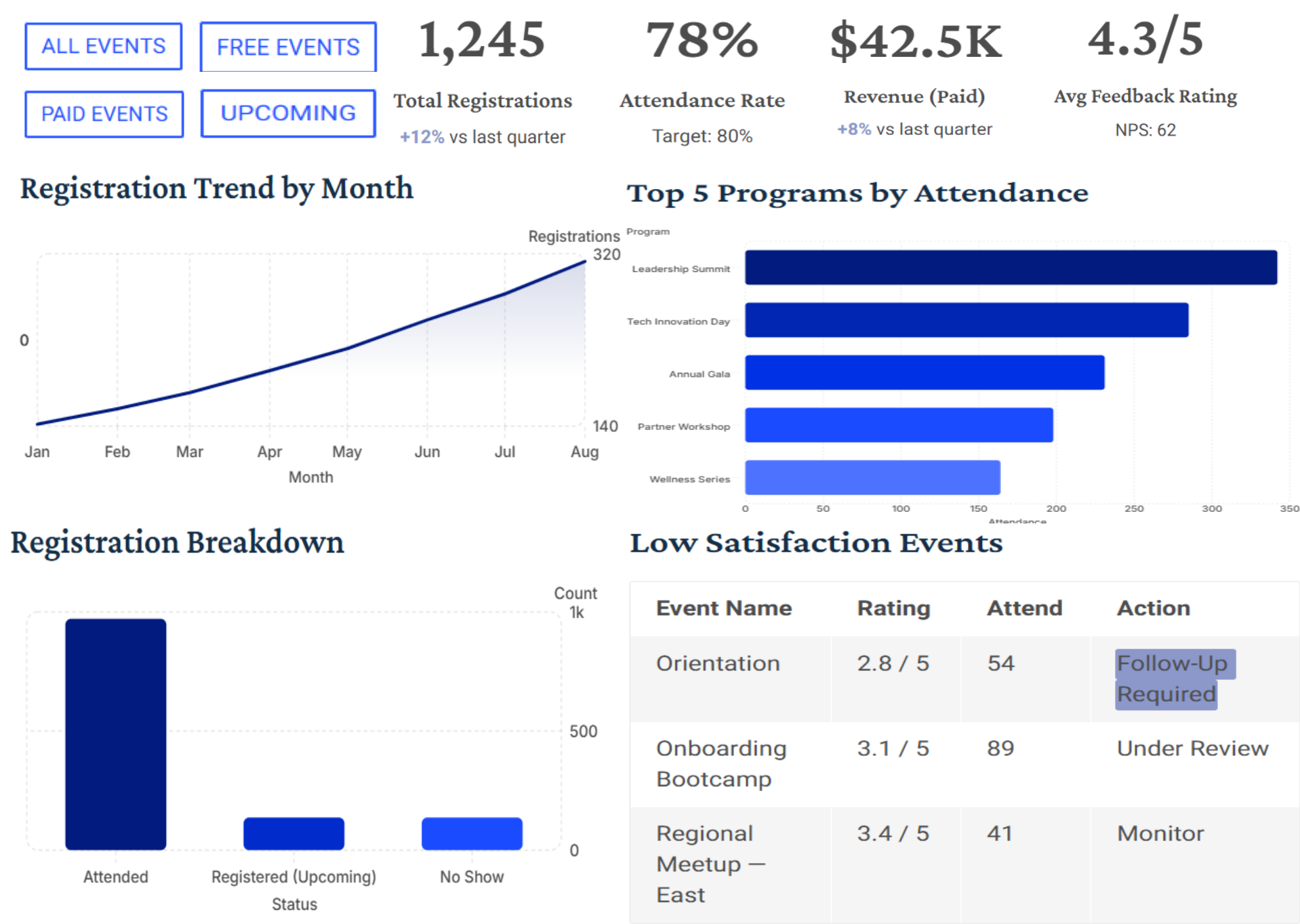
Proposed Automations to Improve the Event Lifecycle

Streamlining operations across registration, attendance tracking, and post-event engagement — reducing manual effort and improving data quality at every stage.

REGISTRATION & PAYMENT Registration Confirmation Flow Auto-sends confirmation email with event details and calendar invite upon registration.	ATTENDANCE & CRM Campaign Member Status Sync Automatically updates Campaign Member status to Registered, Attended, or No Show based on check-in data.	Attendance Roll-Up Metrics Calculates attendee count and attendance rate on the Event record automatically — ready for leadership reporting.
Capacity & Waitlist Control Marks event as "Full" when capacity is reached and notifies the event manager automatically.	FEEDBACK & ESCALATION Post-Event Feedback Trigger Sends a feedback survey to all attendees automatically after event completion.	Low Rating Escalation Rule If feedback rating is ≤ 2, notifies the program manager and creates a follow-up task for resolution.
Payment Status Handling Updates registration status on payment success, failure, or refund — and sends a retry email if payment fails.		
Reduces Manual Workload Fewer administrative updates across the event lifecycle	Improves Engagement Timely, consistent communication with every attendee	
Enhances Data Accuracy Reliable metrics for leadership and reporting teams	Proactive Issue Resolution Escalations triggered automatically before issues escalate	

Executive Event Performance Dashboard

Sample dashboard layout to monitor event performance across registration, revenue, engagement, and satisfaction.



Assumptions & Stakeholder Clarifications

Aligning foundational assumptions with open decision points to ensure project clarity and stakeholder consensus.

Key Assumptions

- **Deduplication Key**
Student ID serves as the primary key for Contact matching and deduplication across systems.
- **Registration Model**
One Event Registration record represents a single student per event instance.
- **Feedback Cardinality**
One feedback submission per registration – a 0..1 optional relationship.
- **System of Record**
Blackthorn owns event operations: registration, attendance tracking, and payment processing.
- **CRM Integration**
Each event maps to a Salesforce Campaign for unified tracking and reporting.

Critical Questions for Stakeholders

- **Success Criteria**
What defines event success – attendance rate, revenue, satisfaction score, or engagement growth?
- **Escalation Triggers**
Should low feedback ratings automatically generate escalation tasks or follow-up workflows?
- **Data Compliance**
Are there compliance or data retention requirements governing payment information?
- **Engagement Scoring**
Should event participation influence student engagement scoring or advisor visibility?
- **Reporting Scope**
Are reporting requirements needed at program, department, or executive level?

Risks & Mitigation Considerations

Duplicate Contacts

Risk: Multiple records for a single student

Mitigation: External ID matching on Student_ID with duplicate rules

Payment Failures

Risk: Incomplete transactions blocking registration

Mitigation: Automated retry workflows with status alerts

Low Feedback Adoption

Risk: Insufficient response rates for insights

Mitigation: Timed reminders at 24hr and 72hr post-event

Data Quality Drift

Risk: Incomplete or inconsistent records over time

Mitigation: Validation rules, required fields, and periodic audits

Business Impact & Organizational Value



OPERATIONAL SCALABILITY

- Structured event lifecycle management through Blackthorn
- Automated workflows reducing manual effort
- Capacity and payment management supporting growth



DATA INTEGRITY & GOVERNANCE

- Clear system-of-record ownership across layers
- Standardized event and registration data model
- Controlled duplicate management and validation logic



ENHANCED STUDENT ENGAGEMENT

- Automated confirmations and reminders
- Attendance-driven campaign tracking
- Feedback capture enabling continuous improvement



EXECUTIVE DECISION ENABLEMENT

- Real-time KPI dashboard (registration, attendance, revenue, satisfaction)
- Cross-program performance visibility
- Data-driven planning and resource allocation

References

Blackthorn and Payments - <https://docs.blackthorn.io/docs/getting-started>

Welcome to Blackthorn events - <https://docs.blackthorn.io/docs/welcome-blackthorn-events>

Getting Started with Salesforce - <https://resources.docs.salesforce.com/latest/latest/en-us/sfdc/pdf/basics.pdf>

Thank You